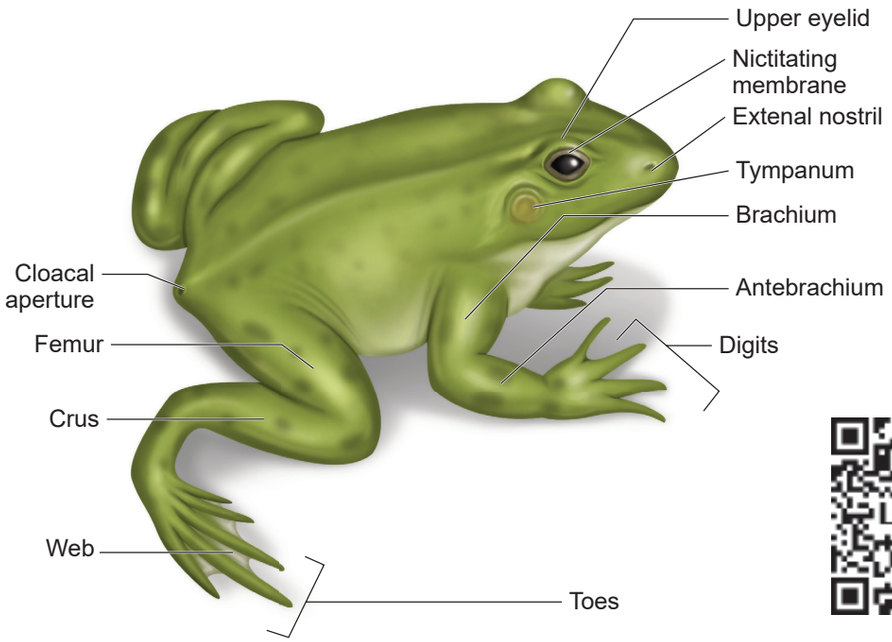


Figure 4.15 *Rana hexadactyla* - External morphology

Table 4.3: Differences between a Frog and Toad

Characters	 Frog	 Toad
Family	Ranidae	Bufonidae
Body shape	Slender	More Bulky
Legs	Longer	Shorter
Webbed feet	present	Absent
Skin	Smooth and moist skin	Dry skin covered with wart like glands.
Teeth	Maxillary and vomerine teeth.	Teeth absent.
Egg formation	Lays eggs in clusters.	Lays eggs in strings.

The body of a frog is **streamlined** to help in swimming. It is dorso-ventrally flattened and is divisible into head and trunk. Body is covered by a smooth, slimy skin loosely attached to the body wall. The skin is dark green on the dorsal side and pale ventrally. The head is almost triangular in shape and has an apex which forms the snout. The mouth is at the anterior end and can open widely.



Order - Anura (Frogs and Toads)

Frogs and toads have bodies specially designed for jumping with greatly elongated hind limbs. Frogs can live in water (aquatic), on land (terrestrial), or on trees (arboreal). Parental care is seen in few species.

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